

Ms. Bernice Gemeniano

Kindergarten 1 Teacher

Mary, Star of the Sea School

Email: bgemeniano@starofthesea.org

Email response hours: Mon–Fri, 7:30 a.m.–3:30 p.m.

School office: (808) 734-0208

MSOS 2026-2027

Kindergarten 1 — Class Syllabus

“Buzz to School” · SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child’s curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

“How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?”

Welcome to Ms. Gemeniano’s K1 Hive

Aloha and welcome to a brand-new school year! I’m so excited to be on this Kindergarten journey with you and your child. It’s my favorite grade to teach, and I know this year will be full of growth, discovery, and lots of joyful learning. With us working together as a team, I’m confident it’s going to be a great year.

School Mission — NUI

In Kindergarten, NUI looks like...

- Nurture: We nurture curiosity through hands-on activities, faith-filled moments, and daily opportunities to explore.
- Unite: We unite by working together on projects, celebrating each other’s successes, and practicing kindness every day.
- Inspire: We are inspired by encouraging new ideas, cheering on brave attempts, and showing that mistakes help us grow.

School Vision: Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith

Guiding Philosophy

Kindergarten is a year of enormous growth. Five- and six-year-olds thrive in a warm, structured environment where they feel safe to be curious, safe to try, and safe to make mistakes. Learning at

this age happens best through play, song, movement, story, and hands-on exploration. Every day in K1 blends structured academic work with joyful discovery, so children build strong foundations in reading, writing, and math while also learning how to be kind classmates, patient friends, and prayerful children of God.

At Mary, Star of the Sea School, we guide our students to become S.T.A.R.s:

- Self-aware, Confident Individuals
- Teachable, Lifelong Independent Learners
- Active Christians
- Responsible Citizens

Contact & Communication

- Email: bgemeniano@starofthesea.org
- I respond to emails during school hours, Monday–Friday, 7:30 a.m.–3:30 p.m.
- You may also send me a note in your child's B.E.E. Binder.
- A weekly newsletter is sent home with classroom updates, what we're learning, important dates, and upcoming events.
- Throughout the year I'll also send emails with reminders, schedule changes, and follow-up information as needed.
- Parent Pouch: Important flyers and notices sent home every Tuesday. Please remove all contents and return the empty pouch on Wednesday.
- Two scheduled Parent-Teacher Conferences during the year, held in Q1 and Q3.

Class Expectations

In K1 our simple rules guide us every day:

- Be Kind — use kind words, kind hands, and kind hearts.
- Be Safe — take care of your body and our classroom.
- Do Your Best — try hard, keep trying, and be proud of your effort.
- Be Christ-like — treat others the way Jesus would.

Positive choices are praised daily and celebrated with our K1 Hive. We use logical consequences to help our little learners grow from mistakes.

Grading

I check daily classwork and homework for effort, thoroughness, and neatness. Writing assessments and class projects are graded using rubrics. I also spend time one-on-one with students to formally assess academic progress. Informal assessments monitor progress during a unit; a summative

assessment concludes each unit or topic.

Report cards go out at the end of each quarter and are graded on a 1–4 scale. Grades reflect performance each quarter (not year-end benchmarks).

1 • Beginning	Student is beginning to understand the concept or skill; requires significant support and guidance; limited understanding or mastery.
2 • Developing	Student demonstrates partial understanding or skill; needs occasional assistance; progressing but with notable gaps.
3 • Proficient	Student meets grade-level expectations; solid understanding; works independently with minimal errors.
4 • Mastery	Student exceeds grade-level expectations; thorough understanding, applies skills to new situations; consistently accurate with higher-level thinking.

Kindergartners also take the STAR Early Literacy assessment in fall, winter, and spring to track growth in phonics and reading. English Language Learners take the WIDA assessment as required. Parent-Teacher Conferences are held after Q1 and Q3.

Homework Routine & B.E.E. Binder (Bring Everything Everyday)

The B.E.E. Binder is your child's daily tool for organization and communication between home and school. It must be brought to school every day. Homework begins August 10 and is completed Monday–Thursday nights (none on Fridays or during long breaks).

Daily Homework

- Kindergarten Sight Words. At the beginning of the year, we spend one week mastering each sight word; as students gain confidence, the pace increases to one word every three days, every two days, or one per day, depending on difficulty and class readiness.
- Please follow the Sight Word Calendar. Practice only the assigned word until all six words in that list have been mastered. The calendar indicates when to review and practice the entire list for fluency. Please avoid introducing future sight words early — the sequence is designed to support long-term mastery.
- Homework Packet. The weekly homework packet lives in the two-pocket folder inside your child's BEE Binder. Sent home every Monday and due Friday (or the last school day before a long break).
- Flashcards as supplemental practice for letter–sound correspondence, upper- and lowercase letter identification, sight words, and number recognition.

Reading Folders

Students receive reading folders with books at their reading level starting in September. Folders go home on Monday and are returned at the end of the school week to receive a new set on Monday.

Kindergarten Curriculum

Quarter-by-quarter arc drawn from our K1 pacing guide.

Language Arts — Sight Words • Phonics • Reading & Writing • Handwriting

- Sight Words: the first 66 words from the Fry List (aligned with the From Sounds to Spelling program).
- Phonics Materials: From Sounds to Spelling Phonics and Spelling Program.
- Phonics • Q1: Student names; Mm, Ss, Aa, Rr, Tt, Ll, Nn, Bb, Oo, Pp, Cc, Ii, Ff, Dd, Hh.
- Phonics • Q2: Uu, Gg, Kk, Ee, Vv, Xx, Jj, Ww, Yy, Qq, Zz • short vowels a and i • CVC words with e, o, u • CVC digraphs sh, th, ch, wh.
- Phonics • Q3: Digraphs qu, ck • CVC words in the -at, -an, -am, -ap, -op, -ot, -ob, -im, -ip, -in, -ill, -ug, -ut, -ed, -et word families.
- Phonics • Q4: Plural nouns and inflectional endings with -s • initial s-blends • initial l-blends • initial r-blends • long a, e, i, o, u • CVCe words.
- Reading & Writing: Q1 Exploring Letters & Sounds, Composing Stories • Q2 Developing Reading Powers & Writing a Personal Story • Q3 Pattern Power & Writing Our Opinion • Q4 Becoming Avid Readers & Writing About a Topic.
- Handwriting: Zaner-Bloser Handwriting book • basic strokes • proper pencil grip and posture • upper- and lowercase letter formation • writing numerals.

Math — Envision Math • Freckle

Materials: Envision Math books, Freckle, manipulatives, iPad, dry-erase boards, Math journals.

- Math Centers
- Numbers 0–20
- Rote counting to 100
- Classify & Count Data
- Understand Addition & Subtraction
- Addition and Subtraction to 10
- 2D and 3D Shapes
- Comparison of Length, Weight, Capacity

Science

Q1 • Engineering, Technology, and Applications of Science

- Scientific Method
- Engineering Design Process

Q2 • Life Science

- Plants and Animals
- Resources in Environments

Q3 • Earth and Space Science

- Weather and Climate

Q4 • Physical Science

- Pushes and Pulls

Social Studies

- Q1 • Civics / History: Learning and Working Together • Time and Chronology
- Q2 • Geography: Geography of the Neighborhood
- Q3 • Economics: Work Now and Long Ago
- Q4 • History: Learning About the Past • National and State Symbols (Hawaiiana Unit)

Religion — Stories of God's Love

Materials: Stories of God's Love textbook • journals • prayer corner.

- God Creates the World
- God's Love Makes Me Who I Am
- God Gives Us Loving People
- Jesus Comes to Us
- Social Emotional Unit
- Celebrating Friendships
- Jesus Shares God's Love
- We Follow Jesus

Family Trips

If you are planning a family trip and your child will miss school, please inform the office and me as soon as possible. The homework will be the routine homework given every day. Your child will complete all missed classwork upon return.

Birthday Protocols

- We will sing Happy Birthday, and your child will receive a birthday crown on or near their special day.
- Please notify me at least 1 week in advance if you plan to send in a treat.
- Cupcakes are not allowed in Kindergarten this school year (per school handbook).

- All treats must be delivered to the front office (not directly to the classroom); store-bought, pre-packaged, easy to distribute; and nut-free.
- We encourage non-food treats like stickers, pencils, or small books.
- Treats are handed out at the end of the school day.
- Birthday Invitations. Invitations may only be distributed at school if the whole class is invited.

Time, Talent, and Treasure

We value any talents you can share with our class. If you'd like to volunteer, please ensure your documentation is up to date with the office.

- Assist with classroom crafts, decorations, and event preparation.
- Chaperone field trips and special activities.
- Share a special skill, hobby, profession, or cultural tradition with our class.
- Contribute items from our classroom wish list or donate materials for classroom projects (completely optional).
- Help organize PTG-sponsored school events.
- Volunteer at school-wide events and activities.
- Assist in recruiting volunteers for school-wide events.

Tentative Daily Class Schedule

There may be minor adjustments, especially during the first few weeks of school as we establish routines. A copy of the finalized daily schedule will be kept in your child's BEE Binder for easy reference throughout the year. If the schedule changes, I will notify you by email and place an updated copy in the BEE Binder.

Kindergarten dismissal is at 2:30 p.m. (pack-up, line-up, and walk to auto line by 2:25).

Final Notes & Acknowledgment

Thank you for entrusting me with your child this year. Kindergarten is a very special year, and I am grateful for your partnership. With God's blessings, I look forward to a wonderful year of faith, learning, and growth together in our K1 Hive.

Many Blessings,
Ms. Bernice Gemeniano

Class website: starofthesea.org/classes — all class pages and syllabi are live there.

Acknowledgment: After reviewing this syllabus, please email bgemeniano@starofthesea.org with the subject line "K1 Syllabus Reviewed — [Student Name]" so I know it has reached your family. Mahalo!

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